
CASE STUDY · GL-CA-ASS-2026-06 · REPORT ID 62FC03EB

What a Safety Walkthrough Actually Finds.

A metals fabrication facility in Statesville, NC brought GigLine in for a combined Safety Walkthrough and Documentation Review. Thirteen findings. One written report. No inspection ever happened — and that is the point.

Vince Lawrence · OSHA 30-Hour Certified · 25+ Years in Manufacturing, Fleet & Warehouse Safety

Location	Headcount	Scope	Visit
Statesville, NC	9 employees	Walkthrough + Docs	Jun 18, 2026
13 Findings 7 serious · 6 documentation	80.3 Compliance Score of 100	4 Days walkthrough → report	

Client name withheld at the client’s request. All findings, citations, and outcomes are accurate to the engagement.
Report ID: 62FC03EB.

THE SITUATION

A 9-person fabrication shop ramping up production.

A 9-person metals fabrication operation in Statesville, NC. Two roll formers, two forklifts, an active flammables cabinet, a growing crew.

The plant manager held an OSHA 30-Hour General Industry certification and had built out most of his safety documentation — some of it using AI-generated templates. He believed his programs were largely in order. He brought GigLine in to confirm that before production scaled.

THE ENGAGEMENT

Combined Safety Walkthrough + Documentation Review.

One on-site visit covering both the physical floor and the written programs. Visit date: June 18, 2026. Written 18-page report delivered June 22, 2026 — four days after the walkthrough.

WHAT THE WALKTHROUGH FOUND

13 findings. 7 serious. 6 documentation gaps.

Compliance score: **80.3 out of 100**. Solid written-program coverage on paper. Targeted gaps underneath it that required immediate attention before full production ramp-up.

Findings that required action before the next production shift:

P2 — SERIOUS Finding 10 **29 CFR 1910.110(b)(6)(i)**

Unsecured propane cylinder adjacent to flammable storage cabinet

One propane cylinder stored upright with no chain, bracket, or restraint — positioned immediately adjacent to the flammable liquids storage cabinet with no separation distance. In a fire event, that arrangement is accelerant against fuel.

Estimated Penalty Exposure: Up to \$16,550 per violation (2026 Serious max)

Corrective Action: Secure immediately. Relocate minimum 20 feet from the cabinet or install a 30-minute fire-rated barrier. Due date: June 20, 2026 — two days out.

P2 — SERIOUS Finding 12 **29 CFR 1910.212(a)(1)**

Unguarded shear point of operation on roll former cut-off mechanism

The shear blade on the roll former cut-off mechanism was accessible during operation. A yellow perimeter rail was present on the outfeed side — it did not address the point of operation at the shear head.

Estimated Penalty Exposure: Up to \$16,550 per violation (2026 Serious max)

Corrective Action: Install point-of-operation guarding before production employees operate the equipment. Due date: before next production run.

Penalty figures are educational estimates based on OSHA published maximum penalty schedules (29 CFR 1903.15 / 2026 adjusted rates). Actual penalties assessed by OSHA vary by employer size, history, good-faith effort, and gravity of the violation.

The documentation picture:

The IIPP existed but was built from an AI-generated template. It listed the wrong facility address. It lacked required elements for management leadership, hazard identification, and program evaluation. It had not been reviewed against actual operations.

The SDS library had one confirmed gap: Star Fire AW46 Hydraulic Oil — a product actively in use at the D-coiler hydraulic power unit, four five-gallon pails on the floor, no SDS on file. That gap alone carries potential serious-citation exposure of up to \$16,550 per violation under 29 CFR 1910.1200(g)(1).

Three required documents were missing entirely: Heat Stress Prevention Plan, Bloodborne Pathogen Exposure Control Plan, and a Corrective Action Log. The Fire Prevention Plan, Container Label System, and Machine Guarding Documentation were present but each had discrete gaps against current standards.

AFTER THE REPORT

From inspection to corrective action in four days.

13
Findings Identified

12 of 13
Closed Within 4 Days

4 Days
To Close 12 of 13

92.3%
Closure Rate

Twelve of 13 findings were closed within four days of the walkthrough — before the formal due date and without pausing production. The one remaining item, the unguarded shear blade on the roll former, has a documented remediation plan: light curtains and a permanent safety fence, to be installed after the machine is set in its final position at the new facility location.

The engagement moved Amero Steel Supply from a compliance score of 80.3 to a post-action rate of 92.3% — with the remaining gap tied to a planned capital improvement, not a documentation failure.

“We knew some of these gaps existed. What we didn’t know was how fast we could close them.”

— **KEVIN STUTTS, PLANT MANAGER, AMERO STEEL SUPPLY**

FINDINGS & CORRECTIVE ACTIONS

What we found. What they did.

Every finding below was identified during the June 18, 2026 walkthrough. Corrective actions were assigned to Kevin Stutts, Plant Manager. 12 of 13 findings were closed within four days of the inspection date.

ID	Issue	Action Taken	Status
CA-001	Written Safety & Health Program required address update to new facility location	Updated all safety and training forms and policies to reflect future address at 170/174 Innovation Drive.	Closed Jun 22
CA-002	SDS Library gap — Star Fire AW46 Hydraulic Oil and Simple Green not in digital library or physical binder	Added SDS for both products to physical binder, digital folder, and internal plant information website.	Closed Jun 22
CA-003	Simple Green spray bottles observed unlabeled — GHS labeling required	Labeled both spray bottles with appropriate GHS-compliant labels.	Closed Jun 22
CA-004	Machine Guarding Documentation present but compliance gaps identified	Added machine guarding policy to new hire orientation.	Closed Jun 22
CA-005	Fire Prevention Plan controls in place informally but not captured in a formal document	Wrote formal Fire Prevention Plan with job-specific tasks and cross-reference to Emergency Action Plan.	Closed Jun 22
CA-006	Heat Stress Prevention Plan not present — required under 29 CFR 1910 General Duty Clause and NC OSHA guidance	Wrote Heat Stress Prevention Plan and added to new hire orientation.	Closed Jun 22
CA-007	No Corrective Action Log present at facility	Created Corrective Action Log; employee training protocol established.	Closed Jun 22
CA-008	Near-Miss / Close-Call Report Log not present — OSHA best practice for identifying hazardous conditions before injury	Created Near-Miss Log and reporting document; training scheduled.	Closed Jun 22

ID	Issue	Action Taken	Status
CA-009	Four 5-gallon pails of AW46 Hydraulic Oil stored on production floor adjacent to D-coiler with no SDS present	SDS added to binder, digital folder, and internal plant website.	Closed Jun 22
CA-010	Propane cylinder stored upright without chain, bracket, or restraint — positioned adjacent to flammables cabinet with no separation distance	Cylinder relocated to forklift storage area away from flammables cabinet; permanent rack planned for new facility.	Closed Jun 22
CA-011	Bloodborne Pathogen Exposure Control Plan not present — required under 29 CFR 1910.1030	Wrote Bloodborne Pathogen Exposure Control Plan and added to new hire training.	Closed Jun 22
CA-012	Shear blade point-of-operation on roll former cut-off mechanism unguarded and accessible during operation	Light curtains and safety fence planned post-relocation; machine will be set in final position at new facility before guarding is installed.	Open — Due Sept 1
CA-013	Employee Safety Handbook required material revision to meet General Duty Clause requirements	Updated all safety documents for compliance; REV numbering system implemented for version tracking.	Closed Jun 22

CONTEXT

What this engagement is not.

No OSHA inspection followed this walkthrough. There is no citation outcome to report.

The value is the written record — a documented baseline of what existed, what was missing, and what needed to change, in the plant manager's hands, before anyone outside the facility looked. **A written record of good-faith corrective action is defensible. A belief that things are in order is not.**

THE PATTERN

Why these findings are not unusual.

The findings at this facility are not unusual. AI-generated documents that don't match actual operations, missing machine-specific procedures, chemical hazards without complete SDS coverage, and physical hazards the team has stopped seeing — these are among the most frequently cited violations in general industry OSHA enforcement.

They show up across facilities of every size. They are also fixable. Most of them don't require a consultant to fix. They require knowing they exist.

AFTER YOU READ THIS

What people ask after reading this engagement.

What if my walkthrough turns up more than 13 findings?

That depends on the facility. A newer operation with a plant manager actively building programs — like the one in this engagement — is going to look different from a 20-year-old facility that hasn't had a third-party review in a decade. More findings isn't a failure. It's information. The report prioritizes every finding by citation risk so you know what to fix first and what can wait.

Does an 80.3 compliance score mean the facility was OSHA-ready?

Not exactly. The compliance score measures written-program coverage. An 80.3 means solid coverage on paper with targeted gaps underneath. The physical findings (the propane cylinder, the unguarded shear blade) are captured separately in the priority ratings. A facility can score well on documentation and still have serious physical hazards. That's why the walkthrough covers both.

What does the written report actually contain?

Every finding documented against the applicable CFR standard, with the specific regulation cited. Photo documentation of physical hazards. A penalty exposure estimate per finding based on OSHA published maximums. A corrective action for each finding with a recommended timeline. A compliance score and a corrective action log pre-populated with every finding. The report in this engagement ran 18 pages and was delivered four days after the walkthrough.

What if I can't fix everything before an OSHA inspection arrives?

Fix the P2 findings first — those are the serious citation risks with dollar exposure attached. A documented corrective action plan with assigned owners and target dates is evidence of good-faith effort. OSHA distinguishes between a facility that knew about a hazard and ignored it and one that identified it, documented it, and was actively working through remediation.

Will GigLine share my findings with anyone?

No. Findings are not shared, published, or referenced without written permission. The engagement in this case study is referenced publicly only because the client permitted it — and the client name is withheld at their request.

Ready to see what's on your floor?

A Safety Walkthrough starts at **\$1,200**. Written report within 48 hours. Fixed quote before scheduling. Everything stays private. Call **(336) 329-8899** or visit **giglinecompliance.com/intake**.